Engineering Ethics Case Study

Case01-6 Confidentiality- Records Relating To Former Client

Presented by: Jawan Ghadanfari & Hoor Alameer

Case Background

1. Engineer A previously worked for Company A investigating defects in a boiler system.
2. Years later, he was hired in a lawsuit involving an explosion at a facility once owned by Company A
3. The defense attorney requested confidential files from Engineer A’s old project.



Stakeholders

01.
Engineer A

*Main stakeholder

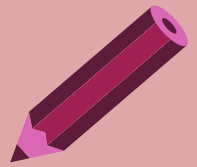
02.
Company A

03.
Attorney X & Defense Attorney

04.
Company B

05.
Victims and families

NSPE Code of Ethics



II.1.c

- Do not reveal confidential information without permission.

II.4

- Engineers must act as faithful agents for clients.

III.4.b

- Avoid conflicts involving former clients.

Ethical Issues

Factual Issues

- No permission was given by Company A.
- No court order required release of files.

Conceptual

- Confidentiality.
- Trust.
- Conflict of interest.

Application Issues

- Protecting confidential information.
- Following the NSPE Code of Ethics.

Moral Issues

- Loyalty toward former clients.
- Maintaining trust in the engineering profession.

The consequences

If Engineer A releases the confidential files, it could expose sensitive company information, damage his professional reputation, and reduce trust in the engineering profession.



Conclusion



Even after a project ends, engineers still have an ethical duty to protect client information. In my opinion, Engineer A should not release the files unless he was legally required to do so or approved by Company A.

Engineering Ethics Case Study

Case21-10 Protecting public health, safety and welfare

Presented by: Jawan Ghadanfari & Hoor Alameer

Case Background

1. Engineer A was hired to design a retraining wall for a house.
2. He noticed sprinkler pipes in an unheated garage that could freeze and fail during a fire
3. The issue is outside his work but creates a safety risk



Stakeholders

01.

Engineer A

*Main stakeholder

02.

Homeowner (Client)

03.

Contractor

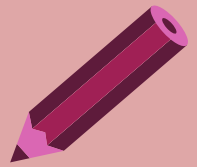
04.

Sprinkler system installer

05.

Emergency responders

NSPE Code of Ethics



I.1

- Engineers must prioritize public safety, health, and welfare

II.1a

- Engineers must act with care and competence

II.1b

- Engineers must not ignore conditions that may endanger the public



Ethical Issues

Factual Issues

- Sprinkler pipes are placed in an unheated garage.
- Freezing could prevent the system from working.

Conceptual

- Scope vs Responsibility.
- Duty of care.

Application Issues

- NSPE Cod e of Ethics requires prioritizing safety.
- Engineer should inform the client about risk.

Moral Issues

- Is it right to ignore a known hazard?
- Duty to speak up to prevent harm.

The consequences

- Sprinkler system may fail → fire damage or injuries.
- Damage to Engineer A’s reputation.
- Possible legal problems.
- Loss of public trust in engineers



Conclusion



- Public safety must come before project limitations.
- Engineer A should report the risk to the client
- Ethical responsibility goes beyond assigned work